

Potential as a Readout

Witnessed Envelopes, Two-Layer Agency, and the Measurement of Pseudo-Peace

A readout-native anatomy of the word “potential” across peace research, capability theory, empowerment, and the Human–AI Readout Programme

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In brief. Problem. “Potential” is the load-bearing word of peace research (violence as the gap between actual and potential realizations), of capability theory (what a person could be and do), of information-theoretic agency (empowerment as channel capacity), and of this programme’s own agency papers (viable regions, admissible regimes, feasible life-space). Every one of these accounts *declares* a set of feasible options and then measures against it; none says how the set itself is read. **Proposal.** Potential is a readout, not a hidden quantity. It is the envelope of a *witnessed* option set (a finite, enumerable set under a retained selection rule), it comes in two layers (choosing within a constraint structure, and changing that structure), it must be kept apart from what was exercised and from what an evaluator observes, and its compression must be diagnosed separately from the attribution of responsibility. **Method.** Seven distinctions are stated as non-collapse rules; the joint-event definition of corrigible agency potential is restated on the witnessed set; corrigibility and spectral support are made readable through a correction-channel presence test and a repair rate; “pseudo-peace” is defined as the collapse of a three-valued evidence gate into a two-valued one and given a numerical signature on a fail-able two-node fixture. **Status.** Definitions at DEFINITION, interpretations at DR, the fixture at FINITE_DIAGNOSTIC on that fixture only; the programme’s own earlier no-go theorem stays a sketch. Four falsifiable propositions are stated with the observation that would defeat each.

1 THE PROBLEM: A WORD EVERYONE MEASURES AGAINST AND NOBODY READS

Peace research made “potential” its hinge. Galtung’s opening definition reads: “violence is present when human beings are being influenced so that their actual somatic and mental realizations are below their potential realizations” [Galtung, 1969, copy p. 3, journal p. 168]. The same essay says at once that “The meaning of ‘potential realizations’ is highly problematic, especially when we move from somatic aspects of human life, where consensus is more readily obtained, to mental aspects” [Galtung, 1969, copy p. 4]. The gap-definition has been used for half a century; the baseline it subtracts from has stayed a declaration.

Other traditions carry the same structure under other names. Capability theory separates what a person achieves from the agency and freedom to achieve it [Sen, 1985, Kabeer, 1999]; social-cognitive theory places agency in intentionality, forethought, self-regulation and self-reflection [Bandura, 2001]; relational sociology indexes agency to a reusable past, an imagined future and a present judgment [Emirbayer and Mische, 1998]; the conversion-process account makes potential depend on micro–meso–macro conversion factors [Bazzani, 2023]. Information-theoretic agency is the cleanest: “We can now define empowerment as the channel capacity of the agent’s actuation channel terminating at the sensor” and “Empowerment is measured in bits. It is zero when the agent has no control

over what it is sensing, and it is higher the more perceivable control or influence the agent has” [Klyubin et al., 2005, copy p. 3]. Power theory supplies the counter-face: “To govern, in this sense, is to structure the possible field of action of others” [Foucault, 1982, copy p. 15].

Inside this programme the word appears four more times. *The Causal Grammar of Structured Coexistence* defines violence as what happens “when incompatible coexistence significantly compresses actors’ feasible life-space” and structure as “an architecture of feasible possibility” [Lahtee, 2026f, pp. 2–3]. *Causal Ethics* makes agency exist “if and only if it can instantiate a choice of regime” from an admissible set [Lahtee, 2026e, Axiom II, p. 9]. *Causal Agency* defines persistence as remaining in a viable region $V \subseteq S$ and agency as modifying the constraint structure C so that expected persistence grows [Lahtee, 2026d, Defs. 2–3, pp. 17–18]. *Violence as a Special Case of Instability* relocates violence from events to unstable modes of a finite-memory operator [Lahtee, 2026k]. A programme note of 5 September 2026 then proposed a joint-event definition of “effective, corrigible agency potential” [Lahtee, 2026b].

All of these share one silent move: a feasible set (Π , R_{adm} , C , the “feasible life-space”, the actuation channel’s alphabet) is *declared*, and potential is then computed as a maximum, a capacity, or a gap over it. Whoever declares the set fixes the potential. This paper’s claim is that the declaration step is where the word must be read, and that the programme’s own

epistemic core already says how.

Central claim. Potential is a readout. It is the envelope of what an agent can bring to a specified task over a *witnessed* option set (a finite, enumerable set under a retained selection rule), read under a declared model, and it is never the envelope over an unretained continuum of “could have”. It comes in two layers (choice within a constraint structure; change of that structure). It must be held apart from what was exercised and from what an instrument observes; its compression is diagnosed from an obstruction ledger and cost asymmetry without naming a culprit; naming a culprit is a separate act that needs a chooser. Anything called “potential” that skips one of these separations is, on this reading, a different quantity wearing the word.

2 PROGRAMME GENEALOGY AND WHAT IS BORROWED FROM THE EPISTEMIC CORE

The four series papers supply the objects; the Readout Genesis / Readout Universe core supplies the reading discipline. The correspondence is exact enough to tabulate (Table 1).

Three pieces of the core are load-bearing here and are cited by their own labels. (i) **N2**, the readout equation: “ $M_A = K_A \cdot \theta + \eta$, $\epsilon_{\text{tot}} > 0$ — knowing is a LOSSY read — never the latent truth” [Lahtee, 2026h, Part VI §VI.1]. (ii) The operator grounding of the ethics ledger, which fixes what “the set of answers actually accessible” means: “a finite, enumerable set under a retained selection rule, never an unbounded continuum of options”, together with the architecture row that defines agency-layer selection as “a finite selection over already-legal moves ... not a continuum optimization” whose checkable content is “whether a specific system’s move-set is actually finite and legal” (Readout Universe, `logic.md` §9.11 and ARCH-L4). (iii) The three-valued verdict gate and the failable gate law: “a two-valued answer/no-answer gate cannot distinguish ‘no evidence exists’ (ABSTAIN) from ‘evidence is genuinely contested’ (ESCALATE)”, and a gate “only counts as Type-P ... if it has both a machine-derived passing control and a machine-derived failing control” [Lahtee, 2026h, Part VI §VI.3, §VI.7]. Corrigibility is already stated there as “boundary-observability”: the channel “through which a human party’s correction or objection must remain visible” (Part V §V.9), and is graded as “a discrete presence/absence readout on a correction channel (open or not, checked at a given time)” (`logic.md` §9.11).

Nothing below adds an axiom to that core. What is added is the application of N2 twice (to the agent’s own option set and to the evaluator’s instrument), the two-layer reading borrowed from *Causal Agency*, and one executed fixture.

3 AN ANATOMY OF “POTENTIAL”: SEVEN DISTINCTIONS

Each distinction is stated as a non-collapse rule: two things the word is used for, which must not be merged, and the failure that merging produces. Two of them are registered in the glosa non-collapse table as NC-78 and NC-79 [Lahtee, 2026i].

D1. Potential $\neq$ exercised $\neq$ observed (NC-78). The envelope p^* of what the agent could do, the policy π_{used} it did use, and the value $Y_{\text{obs}} = \mathcal{O}_q(H)$ an evaluator’s instrument returns are three readouts of three different latents. N2 applies to each. Collapse: reading assisted output as retained capability [Lahtee, 2026g]; reading silence as consent; reading an instrument change as a change in the person.

D2. Declared set $\neq$ witnessed set. A feasible set someone writes down is a declaration; the set of options for which a record exists that an agent with comparable history and conditions executed them within the horizon and budget is a readout. Only the second is finite and enumerable in the required sense. Collapse: computing a maximum or a capacity over options nobody has ever been seen to take, then calling the number potential.

D3. Layer 1 $\neq$ layer 2. Choosing within a constraint structure C is one capacity; changing C (renegotiating a rule, opening a channel, forming a coalition, delegating) is another. *Causal Agency* reserves the word agency for the second: constraint modulation with $\partial T_p / \partial C \cdot \partial C / \partial x > 0$, and calls stabilisation inside a fixed C “proto-agency” [Lahtee, 2026d, §6.5–6.6]. *Causal Grammar*’s “repair” is a layer-2 act under protection. Collapse: reporting a layer-1 envelope as if it bounded what a person or group can become.

D4. Task potential $\neq$ aggregate potential. A profile over tasks $\mathbf{p}^* = (p_g^*)_g$ is the object; a weighted scalar is a summary for comparing interventions under one declared weighting. *Violence as Instability* §7 gives the dynamical reason: “Blocking one expression channel does not remove instability”, load moves to a coupled channel [Lahtee, 2026k, p. 3]. Collapse: a flat aggregate hiding a compression in one task and a rise in another.

D5. Feasible $\neq$ permitted. What has a working path is not the same as what present power allows; to govern “is to structure the possible field of action of others” [Foucault, 1982, copy p. 15]. Changing a rule can be a feasible layer-2 intervention with a named actor, budget and horizon even when it is currently forbidden. Collapse: letting the permitting authority define the feasible set, which makes every compression by that authority invisible by construction.

D6. Diagnosis of compression $\neq$ attribution of responsibility (NC-79). That a capability set has shrunk is read from an obstruction ledger (what was present at the source equals what survived plus what was obstructed at each step; Genesis Part VI §VI.6) and from cost asymmetry: *Causal Ethics* “does not require intent or malice to identify injustice — only asymmetry” (CE-30, p. 20). Who is responsible is answered only by a chooser: “Cost attaches to the chooser, not the carrier of consequences” (p. 20). Collapse in one direction: refusing to call a shortfall deprivation until a culprit is named, which

Table 1: One object, five names. Page locators refer to the Zenodo PDFs; “AP” is the 5 September programme note.

	Causal Grammar	Causal Ethics	Violence as Instability	Causal Agency	AP / this paper
Structure	“architecture of feasible possibility” (p. 2)	regime $R = (T_R, I_R)$, CE-05	generator L_τ (eq. 5)	constraint structure C (Def. 1)	option set Π^{wit}
Potential	“feasible life-space” (p. 3)	$R_{\text{adm}}(t')$	viable region of the state manifold	viable region $V \subseteq S$ (Def. 2)	envelope p^* , profile $\mathbf{p}^*$, capability set $\mathcal{C}^\alpha$
Agency	actors sustaining structures	“ $\exists R_A \in R_{\text{adm}}$ selected by A ” (Axiom II)	—	$\partial T_p / \partial C \cdot \partial C / \partial x > 0$ (Def. 3)	D_g actor-directed choice; layer 2
Violence	“compresses actors’ feasible life-space”	spectral exclusion $\Delta_{\text{spec}}(R_i) \leq 0$	instability under sustained load	(not defined)	shrinkage of $\mathcal{C}^\alpha$
Repair	“protected reopening” (p. 3)	$\dot{V} \leq 0 \wedge \tau'_c > 0 \wedge \Delta_{\text{spec}} > 0$	$\Gamma \uparrow, S_{\text{env}} \downarrow, L_{ij} \downarrow, \tau \downarrow$	$C_{t+1} = G(x_t, C_t)$	F_g correction channel; layer 2
Responsibility	—	$\text{Resp}(A) \equiv C_{A,R_A};$ forced regime $\Rightarrow C_{A,R} = 0$	—	—	attribution, separate from diagnosis

silences the no-chooser structural case that *Violence as Instability* §6.2 exists to capture. Collapse in the other: inferring a culprit from asymmetry alone.

D7. Recoverable gap $\neq$ accumulated loss. Galtung’s own examples turn on avoidability (tuberculosis in the eighteenth century versus today, copy p. 3). A gap that a feasible intervention within the study’s horizon can reopen is one quantity; damage already fixed into history is another. A recoverable gap of zero is not evidence that no violence occurred.

4 DEFINITIONS ON THE WITNESSED SET

4.1 Objects

Let $g \in \mathcal{G}$ be a specified agency task (to accept or decline, to ask for an explanation, to delegate, to revise a decision when information changes). Let A be the agent, h its retained and usable history, z the social and material conditions (tools, resources, relations, whether objection is acknowledged), T a declared horizon, B a declared budget, P the declared transition-and-readout model (not the world), q_g, v_g the outcome resolution and declared test set, and $w_g \geq 0, \sum_g w_g = 1$, summary weights.

Witness rule (D2 made operational). $\Pi_A^{\text{wit}}(g; h, z, T, B)$ is the finite set of policies for which a retained record exists that an agent with history and conditions comparable to (h, z) executed the policy within T and B . Assistance, tools, interpreters and delegates are part of a policy when the agent actually reaches them and directs the relevant part. A policy that is merely conceivable, or permitted only in principle, is not in the set. Adding a policy to the set is itself a recordable act (a new witness), which is how layer-2 agency enters (Section 4.3).

4.2 The joint event and the envelope

For task g define four events under P : R_g (the agent reads the distinctions the decision needs, including its own uncertainty),

D_g (acceptance, refusal or choice counts as the agent’s own direction under declared criteria, with coercion and delegation checked), X_g (the choice turns into the relevant action or outcome, with a causal contrast that separates the choice from luck or from another’s order), F_g (feedback, objection and revision remain usable within the horizon when there is reason to revise). F_g does not require reversing events or changing one’s mind on every objection; a reasoned reaffirmation passes.

$$p_{A,g}^*(h, z; T, B, P) := \max_{\pi \in \Pi_A^{\text{wit}}(g; h, z, T, B)} \Pr_P^\pi(R_g \cap D_g \cap X_g \cap F_g), \quad (1)$$

with $p_{A,g}^* := 0$ when the set is empty (no witnessed path, not a verdict on the person). The primary objects are the profile and the capability set,

$$\mathbf{p}_A^* = (p_{A,g}^*)_{g \in \mathcal{G}}, \quad \mathcal{C}_A^\alpha = \{g : p_{A,g}^* \geq \alpha\}, \quad (2)$$

and only for comparing interventions under one declared w ,

$$A_A^{\text{corr}}(h, z; T, B, P, w) := \sum_g w_g p_{A,g}^* \in [0, 1]. \quad (3)$$

Because the maximum is over a finite witnessed set, (1) is computable from records. Its relation to any larger “true” envelope is N2: what is read is $K \cdot \theta + \eta$ with $\epsilon_{\text{tot}} > 0$; the unread remainder is not a smaller number waiting to be found but a non-readout. This is not a retreat from “envelope”: the envelope is defined on what is retained, which is the only place an envelope was ever a quantity.

By the chain rule, for one policy on one task, $p_{A,g}(\pi) = r dx f$ with $r = \Pr(R_g)$, $d = \Pr(D_g | R_g)$, $x = \Pr(X_g | R_g, D_g)$, $f = \Pr(F_g | R_g, D_g, X_g)$; the maximum is taken of the product under one policy, never of the four factors separately (which would assemble an ideal person from parts of incompatible policies). The factorisation order is not a causal chain; mechanism needs timing and intervention contrasts.

4.3 Two layers

Let $\mathcal{J}_{\text{feas}}$ be the witnessed set of interventions on conditions z (rule changes, reallocations, channel openings), each with

a named actor, budget, horizon and effect on others; z_0 the present conditions. Layer-1 potential is (1) at fixed z . Layer-2 potential is

$$p_{A,g}^{*(2)} := \max_{z \in \mathcal{J}_{\text{feas}}} p_{A,g}^*(h, z; T, B, P), \quad (4)$$

and the recoverable gap of the earlier note is exactly the difference of the two layers summed under w :

$$L_A^{\text{recoverable}} = \max_{z \in \mathcal{J}_{\text{feas}}} A_A^{\text{corr}}(h, z) - A_A^{\text{corr}}(h, z_0). \quad (5)$$

This is the quantity to bring to Galtung’s baseline problem: not “potential realizations” in general, but the part of the gap that a witnessed intervention inside the study’s horizon can reopen (D7). It is in the units of (3), not in units of violence.

4.4 Corrigibility and spectral support made readable

Causal Ethics requires, for a collective, $\frac{d}{dt} V_G \leq 0$ and $\min_i \Delta_{\text{spec}}(R_i) > 0$, and reads the second condition as the exclusion of “an illusion of stability: a situation in which V_G decreases while one or more agencies lose spectral support ... where apparent collective order is maintained by suppressing, marginalizing, or erasing subgroups” [Lahtee, 2026e, ch. 6]. For a social regime Δ_{spec} has no instrument of its own. The core supplies two: the correction-channel presence readout (open or not, checked at a time) and the repair rate $dR_H/dt = -\mu \|\text{Res}_H\|^2$ from the agency loop [Lahtee, 2026h, Part VIII §VIII.4]. This paper therefore reads, for subgroup i ,

$$\Delta_{\text{spec}}(R_i) > 0 \iff \text{channel}_i = \text{open} \wedge \dot{R}_i \neq 0 \quad (6)$$

as a readout-level sufficient condition; both conjuncts are retained-record tests, not judgments of sentiment. F_g in (1) is the same object at task level.

4.5 Identifiability

The evaluator reads $Y_{\text{obs}} = \mathcal{O}_q(H_{0:T})$. Let $\mathfrak{M}(\mathcal{D})$ be the models not yet excluded by record $\mathcal{D}$; the set of potentials $\{A_A^{\text{corr}}(P) : P \in \mathfrak{M}(\mathcal{D})\}$ is what the record supports, and if two models agree on every record under the declared tests but disagree on potential, no function of the record alone can return the right value in both cases. The programme’s own worked case of this gate is the “no objection voiced” row: consent, fear of reprisal, no channel, objection through a proxy — separated only by additional records (a private channel, a history of proxy use, the response when a real alternative is offered). Two model families P_1, P_2 can differ on $\inf_P \max_\pi$ versus $\max_\pi \inf_P$; choosing a policy robust to model uncertainty is a separate problem and is left as such.

5 PSEUDO-PEACE: A GATE COLLAPSE WITH A NUMERICAL SIGNATURE

Causal Grammar lists “Pseudo-peace” as its own regime: “Compatible appearance / Restricted / Suppressed”, beside

Table 2: Two-node fixture ($L_R = D_W - W$, $\varepsilon = 0.05$, $\tau = 1$, $dt = 0.1$, threshold 1.0, sustained load $J_1 = 0.05$, $\gamma = 0.02$ unless changed). Tier FINITE_DIAGNOSTIC on this fixture only. Script and result file: Lahtee [2026c], `sim/nogo_fixture.py`.

Intervention	threshold crossings	force spent
none	1 (stays above)	0
amplitude reset, bounded budget (4000 ticks), then stopped	recurs after budget	18.08
amplitude reset, unbounded, 8000 ticks	0	36.45
amplitude reset, unbounded, 16000 ticks	0	73.18
operator change ($\gamma: 0.02 \rightarrow 0.20$, $J_1: 0.05 \rightarrow 0.02$), no resets	0	0

“Peace”: “Compatible / Preserved / Protected” [Lahtee, 2026f, Table 1, p. 4]. In the language of Section 4 the regime is defined by three readouts taken together:

$$Y_{\text{obs}} \text{ calm} \wedge p_{\text{wit}}^* \text{ low} \wedge F \text{ blocked}. \quad (7)$$

Epistemically it is the collapse of the three-valued verdict gate: the evaluator returns ABSTAIN (no signal) in a state that is ESCALATE (contested) with the channel closed. The gate law says a two-valued gate cannot tell these apart; pseudo-peace is what a two-valued reading of a society looks like.

Violence as Instability gives the dynamics: force “alters amplitudes c_k but leaves the spectrum invariant”, and its no-go statement is that “no bounded force-based intervention can drive the system to a globally violence-free absorbing state” under three premises [Lahtee, 2026k, §4–5]. That statement is a sketch at DR. What can be done now, without upgrading it, is to ground premise (ii) on the forced operator ($L_R = D_W - W$, machine-checked as the operator retained distinction forces; Genesis one-line master equation) — suppression enters the spine as a state or source term, never as W or the dissipation — and to build a fail-able fixture for the reading.

Table 2 reports the fixture. The earliest version of the fixture set the wrong passing control (it expected recurrence *during* suppression) and failed its own control: continuous resets do hold the amplitude down. Re-reading the theorem’s wording (“bounded”, “absorbing”) fixed the specification and the result raised, not lowered, the claim: amplitude-only suppression keeps the readout below threshold exactly as long as it is paid for, the cumulative force grows without bound (the cost-divergence *Causal Ethics* names as CE-31, $\lim_{T \rightarrow \infty} C_{A,R}[0, T] = \infty$), the neighbouring channel rises (mutation), and a bounded budget is followed by recurrence; an operator-level change reaches the same calm with zero ongoing force. The failing control that would defeat the reading is stated in the script: bounded suppression with no recurrence while the load’s time-average stays positive. It did not trigger. Nothing here transfers to real societies; it is the reading, made fail-able on the operator the core forces.

6 CONVERSATION WITH THE LITERATURE

The comparison below is a reading of the sources listed, with verbatim passages only where the text was fetched and read for this paper; entries marked “record” were consulted at record level and are not quoted. It is not a systematic review.

7 FALSIFIABLE PROPOSITIONS

Each is DR/OPEN with a stance and the observation that would defeat it. Tests need passing and failing controls (correct and incorrect information; a channel that works and one whose submissions vanish) and must not manufacture coercion or risk for real participants to obtain a failing control.

P-A (pseudo-peace signature). Amplitude-suppressing interventions raise the calm an evaluator reads while p_{wit}^* does not rise and F stays blocked. Defeated if p_{wit}^* rises consistently with observed calm under such interventions.

P-B (channel shift). When F is blocked and $\mathcal{C}^\alpha$ shrinks in task g , load rises in a coupled task g' while the aggregate (3) stays flat. Defeated if profiles stay flat across tasks.

P-C (the excluded path). Groups whose $\min_i |\mathcal{C}_{A_i}^\alpha|$ falls while the mean rises show persistent cost concentration (CE-30) and higher recurrence than groups whose minimum does not fall. Defeated if no difference is found.

P-D (layer 2 dominates the structural case). In cases *Violence as Instability* classifies as structural (§6.2), the gap closable by layer-2 interventions exceeds the gap closable by layer-1 ones. Defeated if information-only or within-C interventions close as much.

The earlier note’s P1–P4 (information alone may not reopen potential where execution is the bottleneck; productivity and corrigible agency can come apart; a change of instrument can reorder rankings while capability is unchanged; keeping the objection channel predicts error-correction beyond resource or confidence scores) are carried unchanged [Lahtee, 2026b].

8 WHAT IS NOT CLAIMED, AND THE LIMITS OF THIS NOTE

Not claimed: that (1) is forced from the root of the epistemic core; that all human agency reduces to one number; that R, D, X, F are necessary or sufficient for every definition of agency; that this reading predicts data better than capability theory, conversion theory or empowerment; that any programme or curriculum is effective; that the two-node fixture says anything about a society; that internal review by the author and an AI assistant amounts to independent human review. If earlier work can deliver the same separations and tests directly, its language should be used and this note reduced to an operational protocol. *Causal Ethics’* Δ_{spec} for social regimes remains without an instrument beyond (6), and its “ $\gg$ ” in CE-30 has no declared threshold; both are per-case declarations. The no-go statement of *Violence as Instability* stays a sketch. Three of the cited works were consulted at

record level only and are not quoted; one open-access source could not be fetched on the day of writing.

9 CONCLUSION: WHAT THE WORD NOW MEANS

Potential, on this reading, is the envelope of a witnessed option set for a specified task under a declared model; it is read, not found. It has two layers, and the recoverable gap between them is the only part of Galtung’s baseline that a study can subtract with a record behind it. It is one of three readouts of an agent that must be kept apart, and its compression is diagnosed before, and separately from, anyone being held responsible. A society that reads calm where the channel is closed has collapsed a three-valued gate into a two-valued one, and the fixture shows what that costs: calm that lasts exactly as long as the force is paid, with a bill that does not stop growing. Everything above is a readout of the sources named, at the tiers stated, and is open to correction through the channels this paper says must stay open.

AI-assistance disclosure. Drafting, source fetching, passage extraction and the fixture were done with an AI assistant under the author’s direction; the problem, the questions and the selection of what to claim are the author’s. No AI or vendor is an author. Verbatim source passages were mechanically extracted from the fetched copies named in the bibliography. The author’s raw lines behind this note are in the Blackbox Log (concept DOI 10.5281/zenodo.22302518, entries BBL-2026-09-05-129 to -132).

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Table 3: What each tradition gives the problem, and what it forces this paper to do. Comparison = same / different / cited; no priority is claimed.

Work	What it supplies	What it forces here
Galtung [1969] (read)	the gap definition; its author's own warning that "potential realizations" is "highly problematic"	D7 and (5): subtract only a witnessed, horizon-bounded baseline; keep the recoverable gap apart from accumulated loss
Galtung [1990] (read)	cultural violence as "those aspects of culture ... that can be used to justify or legitimize direct or structural violence" (copy p. 2)	legitimation is read as a change to what can be read, which options count, and whether objection has a channel; no whole culture is scored
Sen [1985], Kabeer [1999] (record)	agency/well-being split; resources–agency–achievements	weights and task lists are not the evaluator's alone; conversion, not attendance or income, is what (1) tests
Bandura [2001], Emirbayer and Mische [1998] (record)	personal/proxy/collective agency; temporal-relational agency	delegated help the agent directs counts inside a policy; h , T and layer 2 keep $\mathcal{G}$ and Π from being fixed for life
Bazzani [2023] (record)	agency as a conversion process with context-dependent factors	the closest sibling: "potential depends on conversion" is not this paper's contribution; what is added is the witness rule, the identifiability gate and the corrigibility test per event
Foucault [1982] (read)	power as structuring "the possible field of action of others"	D5: the feasible set must never be defined by the permitting authority
Pettit [1997], Fricker [2007], Mahmood [2001] (record)	non-domination; testimonial and hermeneutical injustice; situated, embodied agency	channel stability under another's discretion; the system's reading of the agent as well as the agent's reading of the world; consent is never read as docility nor culture used to erase real constraint
Klyubin et al. [2005] (read)	empowerment as channel capacity in bits	the nearest information-theoretic ancestor; this paper adds task criteria, actor direction and corrigibility, and reads the alphabet as a witnessed set
Csaky [2026] (structure read)	prediction / identification / empowerment separations across bridge interfaces	"reading is not controlling" is already developed there; what remains to test here is ownership, contestability and the social layer
Satha-Anand [2021] (read)	"there are indeed nonviolent alternatives to violence ... based on solid social sciences and humanities" (p. 6)	alternatives must be witnessed and must change power relations; widening a list is not widening Π^{wit}

Michel Foucault. The subject and power. *Critical Inquiry*, 8 (4):777–795, 1982. doi: 10.1086/448181. Passage read from the Kobe University teaching copy, p. 15 of the copy.

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